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Submitter Information

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General Comment

I am writing in response to the National Science Foundation's request for information on the development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan. As a professional writer who makes a living through my creative and intellectual work, I recognize AI's potential to enhance various industries, including writing, research, and healthcare. However, I am deeply concerned about the risks AI poses to copyright protections, data ownership, health equity, and overall accountability. Without proper safeguards, AI can be used in ways that exploit individuals, violate privacy, and in healthcare settings, even cost lives.

While AI can serve as a valuable tool, its use must be governed by strong protections to ensure that copyrighted material is not exploited without consent or compensation. Many AI models are trained on massive datasets that include copyrighted content, often without the knowledge or permission of creators. This practice threatens the livelihoods of writers, artists, and other professionals whose work is their primary source of income. The AI Action Plan must explicitly address how AI companies will be held responsible for respecting copyright laws and ensuring fair compensation for those whose work is used in training models.

Beyond the impact on creative professionals, I am particularly concerned about the role of AI in healthcare and health-related data. AI-driven decision-making in medical settings has already led to serious, sometimes deadly, consequences when not properly tested, ethically designed, or effectively regulated. Biases embedded in AI models—due to incomplete, non-representative, or discriminatory data—can lead to misdiagnoses, denial of critical treatments, and the reinforcement of existing health inequities. If AI is used to determine who receives care or how medical resources are allocated, unchecked bias can quite literally be a matter of life and death.

Additionally, the handling of sensitive health data raises major ethical concerns. AI tools are increasingly used to process patient records, insurance claims, and even predictive health analytics. However, without robust protections, this data can be misused, leading to breaches of privacy, discrimination, and exploitation. Patients must have full control over their own health data, and AI companies must be held to strict ethical and legal standards to ensure data security and responsible use.

Finally, AI developers and corporations must be held accountable for harm caused by their technologies. Whether through bias in AI models, misinformation, or economic disruptions, the consequences of AI misuse can be severe. There must be clear legal mechanisms that allow individuals and organizations to challenge AI-driven decisions and seek redress when harm occurs. Companies profiting from AI should bear responsibility for mitigating risks and addressing negative outcomes.

I urge the National Science Foundation to develop an AI Action Plan that prioritizes ethical guidelines, strong regulatory frameworks, and accountability mechanisms. AI should be designed to support human creativity, health, and innovation—not to undermine the rights and livelihoods of those who create original content or to endanger lives through unchecked automation. I appreciate the opportunity to provide input on this critical issue and look forward to policies that balance AI's potential benefits with essential protections.